PROPER HOME PREP

Nashville, TN

EMPLOYEE ONBOARDING PLAN

& Implementation Guide

"Where Every Detail Matters."

2026 Edition | Companion to The Proper Standard Operations Playbook

Confidential — Internal Use Only

Why This Document Exists

The Proper Standard already tells your team what “done right” looks like once someone is on a job site. This guide is the missing piece before that: it is your playbook, as the owner, for turning a new hire into a fully certified Proper Home Prep technician — predictably, the same way, every time.

Treat this as a checklist you run once per hire, not something you improvise. The goal is that hiring employee #10 feels exactly as smooth as hiring employee #2.

The Core Idea

Build the onboarding system once. Reuse it every time you hire.

Every step below maps to a specific deliverable in Section 11 (Onboarding Certification Checklist) of The Proper Standard — this guide tells you how to actually execute that checklist without scrambling.

Choosing Your Employment Structure

You don't need a brick-and-mortar location to have W-2 employees — location isn't part of the legal test. What matters is how much control you exercise over the work (schedule, methods, SOPs, uniform, dashboard sign-off). Given how The Proper Standard is written, your model reads as classic employee control, so this table is meant to help you and your accountant weigh the real trade-off: how much of that control you want to keep versus how much admin burden you want to hand off.

Option	Cost	Control You Retain	Compliance Burden on You
W-2 Employees (direct)	Lowest per-hour cost. You pay payroll software/service fees plus employer payroll taxes and workers' comp.	Full — you set schedule, SOPs, uniform, dashboard requirements without restriction.	Highest — you own EIN, SUI registration, new-hire reporting, I-9s, payroll tax filing, workers' comp.
PEO (co-employer)	Moderate — monthly per-employee fee (often $40–$150/employee) on top of wages.	High — you still direct daily work; PEO handles the paperwork behind it.	Low — PEO co-files payroll taxes, handles new-hire reporting, often bundles workers' comp.
EOR (employer of record)	Higher — typically the highest per-employee fee of these options.	High — similar to a PEO; EOR is sole legal employer but you still direct work.	Lowest — EOR is the legal employer of record; almost all compliance sits with them.
Staffing Agency	Highest hourly cost — you pay a markup over the worker's wage.	Low — agency controls hiring, discipline, and often scheduling.	Lowest — agency is the employer; best for short-term surge labor, not a core team.
Independent Contractors (genuine)	No employer payroll tax or workers' comp — but requires giving up standardization.	Low — contractors set their own methods, tools, and schedule; can't mandate uniform or exact SOP steps.	Moderate — still must avoid misclassification; 1099 filing required.

Rule of Thumb

If the goal is avoiding payroll admin — not avoiding control — a PEO is usually the best fit for a business like yours: you keep the SOPs, uniforms, and dashboard sign-off intact, and hand off the tax filings and new-hire reporting.

If the goal is genuinely flexible, uncontrolled labor, independent contractors can work — but only if you're willing to loosen the standardization The Proper Standard is built around.

The Onboarding Timeline at a Glance

Certification takes three weeks and mirrors Section 11 of The Proper Standard. Build your hiring calendar around this rhythm so you always know what stage a new hire is in.

Stage	What Happens
Pre-Day 1 (1–2 weeks before start)	Paperwork, background check, uniform sizing, PPE kit prep, dashboard account creation, schedule the shadow shift.
Week 1 — Orientation	Read & acknowledge The Proper Standard, safety orientation, uniform/PPE issued, vehicle walkthrough, dashboard training, shadow one full job.
Week 2 — Field Training	3 supervised jobs covering turnover, make-ready, and one other type. Supervisor signs off on photos, damage reporting, and sign-off procedure.
Week 3 — Independent Work	3 independent jobs reviewed after the fact. Zero sign-off rejections required to certify.
Day 45	Mid-point probationary check-in (required by Section 4.6).
Day 90	Full probationary review. Passing confirms continued employment.

Step-by-Step: What You Need To Do

1. Build Your Onboarding Kit Once

Assemble a reusable physical and digital kit so you're never scrambling the night before someone starts. This is the single biggest thing that makes onboarding "easy" — it turns a stressful one-off into a repeatable checklist.

Physical kit (keep 1–2 ready at all times)

- Branded uniform top (order in common sizes ahead of time: S–XL)
- PPE kit: nitrile gloves, N95 respirator masks, safety glasses, back support belt
- Printed copy of The Proper Standard (or a tablet/link to the digital version)
- Blank Onboarding Certification Checklist (Section 11) and Acknowledgment page (Section 13)
- Emergency Contact Sheet (Section 5.8) pre-filled with your business's actual numbers

Digital kit

- Dashboard account creation steps documented (so you or a supervisor can do it in under 5 minutes)
- Offer letter template
- New hire paperwork packet: I-9, W-4, direct deposit form, emergency contact form

- A shared calendar invite template for the Day 45 and Day 90 review

2. Standardize Your Pre-Day-1 Checklist

Everything below should happen before a new hire's first shift, ideally 3–5 business days out:

1. Send offer letter and confirm start date.
2. Collect new hire paperwork (tax forms, I-9, direct deposit, emergency contact).
3. Confirm uniform size and PPE fit; pull from kit or order.
4. Create dashboard login and send credentials.
5. Schedule Week 1 shadow shift with an experienced technician (or yourself, early on).
6. Block your own calendar for the Week 1 orientation session — this needs your direct time.

3. Run Week 1 Exactly the Same Way Every Time

Use Section 11, Week 1 of The Proper Standard as your literal script. In practice, this looks like:

- Morning: sit down together and go through The Proper Standard section by section — don't just hand it over silently. Give context on why the standards exist.
- Have them sign the Acknowledgment & Signature Page (Section 13) the same day.
- Do the safety orientation and PPE issue as a hands-on walkthrough, not a lecture.
- Do the vehicle walkthrough together — storage, equipment, emergency items.
- Log into the dashboard together and click through all three screens (Jobs, Checklist, Reports) using a test or low-stakes job.
- End the week with a full shadow shift, start to finish, on a real job.

4. Make Weeks 2–3 Self-Tracking

The dashboard already does most of the tracking work for you — you don't need a separate spreadsheet. To keep it easy:

- At the start of Week 2, tell the new hire explicitly which 3 job types they need supervised (turnover, make-ready, one other).
- Review their dashboard photo documentation and damage-reporting workflow after each of those 3 jobs — not just at the end of the week.
- For Week 3, review completed dashboard records for all 3 independent jobs before their certification date. “Zero sign-off rejections” is the bar — if something fails, extend independent review rather than certifying early.
- Certify on the Onboarding Certification page (Section 11) once every box is checked — both signatures, dated.

5. Put Day 45 and Day 90 on the Calendar Immediately

The moment someone starts, schedule both review dates — don't rely on remembering later. A quick recurring calendar event, or a note in the dashboard, prevents these from slipping.

- Day 45: informal but documented check-in on attendance, attitude, and job quality.
- Day 90: formal review — job quality (dashboard records), attendance, professionalism, communication, growth. Passing confirms continued employment.

6. Fill the Placeholders Before You Hire

The Proper Standard currently has three sections marked as placeholders. These need real numbers before your first hire, or Week 1 orientation will hit an awkward gap:

- Compensation & Pay Structure (Section 4, pay rate, frequency, overtime, reimbursements)
- Tips Policy (Section 4)
- Mileage Reimbursement (Section 4)
- Technology Stack (Section 12 — dispatch, invoicing, CRM, STR calendar tools) once those are chosen

These don't need to be complex — even a simple flat rate and a stated mileage reimbursement rate is enough to start. What matters is that a new hire never hears “we haven't figured that out yet” on day one.

Owner's Quick-Reference: What Makes This Easy

Do this once, use it forever

1. Pre-built onboarding kit (physical + digital) ready before you post the job listing.
2. A single offer-to-paperwork packet you send as one email.
3. Week 1 run as a fixed script, not improvised.
4. Dashboard does the Week 2–3 tracking — you just review it.
5. Day 45 / Day 90 reviews calendared on day one, every time.

As you hire your first few employees, keep notes on anything that felt clunky — a form that was missing, a step nobody remembered — and fold the fix into this document. That's what keeps onboarding a system instead of a scramble.